

KENYA

Tea was first introduced to Kenya in 1903, and its commercial production began in 1924. Since then, the Kenyan tea industry has become known for its black teas, demand for which has made the country the third largest producer in the world.

Tea in Kenya is grown at high altitudes, up to 8,850ft (2,700m), in the volcanic red soils of the highlands of the Rift Valley. Owing to their location on the Equator, tea-growing regions of Kenya receive heavy rainfall and abundant sunshine, as well as cooler temperatures owing to the high elevation. These offer ideal conditions for growing tea, and allow for a year-long harvest.

Kenya grows *Camellia sinensis* var. *sinensis*, and produces about 5 percent orthodox tea, with the rest entirely black CTC (see p21). Kenyan CTC is popular

in classic breakfast teas, lending a familiar flavor associated with a round and full blend. Some larger granules of CTC tea are enjoyed as loose leaf tea rather than in tea bags.

Tea is mainly grown in the highlands on either side of the Great Rift Valley, namely the Kericho, Nandi, Nyeri, and Muranga regions, on farms of 1 acre (0.40 hectare) or less. The Kenya Tea Development Agency (KTDA) has been responsible for the success of small farms participation in the industry.



HARVESTING

Almost 90 percent of Kenya's tea is hand picked and produced using the orthodox method.

KENYA KEY FACTS

PERCENTAGE
OF WORLD
MARKET:

7.9%

HARVEST:

**JANUARY-
DECEMBER**

MAIN TYPE:

**BLACK,
GREEN, WHITE**

ELEVATION:

HIGH

FAMOUS FOR:

**LARGE, HIGH-YIELD
PRODUCTION AREAS**



Mariny,
a spicy and
full-bodied black
tea is grown in the
Kenyan highlands
between Mount Kenya
and Lake Victoria.